Quarterly Business Review – Midwest Region

Date: 10-Oct-2025

Participants: Regional Sales Director, Territory Managers, Selected Sales Reps

1. Performance Overview

- The Midwest region shows solid year-to-date sales growth for M&M's.

- Operating margin is slightly below the South and West regions.

- Several grocery accounts have used deeper discounting to drive volume, which is affecting profitability on family-size packs.

2. Key Insights from Reps

- Peanut and Peanut Butter variants are performing particularly well in suburban areas.

- Minis are gaining traction where they are listed, especially near checkouts.

- Some stores report inconsistent execution of promotional signage, leading to confusion for shoppers and store staff.

3. Challenges Identified

- Heavy reliance on price promotions in a few large accounts is eroding margin.

- Out-of-stock incidents during peak shopping hours are still being reported.

- Visibility and space share in seasonal aisles vary significantly by retailer and store.

4. Agreed Action Items

- Review depth and frequency of discounts for top Midwest accounts and adjust where necessary to protect margin.

- Identify 10–15 underperforming outlets for focused field activation and improved shelf visibility for M&M's.

- Pilot a "perfect store" checklist for the region, including:

  - Minimum facings per SKU.

  - Standard shelf positions.

  - Requirements for promotional signage and secondary displays.

- Use structured field sales data to build a new regional dashboard, tracking:

  - Region-wise performance.

  - State/city-wise trends.

  - Rep-wise sales and margin metrics.

5. Next Steps

- Territory Managers to share shortlist of candidate stores for the "perfect store" pilot.

- Trade marketing team to propose updated promotional guidelines for the Midwest by early November.

- Follow-up review scheduled for next quarter to assess impact of the new initiatives.